GRADUATE EMPLOYABILITY

THINK YOU CAN BUILD

Turn problem-solving into visible proof.

A live challenge show where graduates tackle business problems on camera, helping employers see how they think beyond the CV.



LIVE • ON CAMERA

BEYOND THE CV

THE PROBLEM

THE EXPERIENCE GAP

Capable graduates can be hard to assess before their first job.

Employers often have limited evidence of how an early-career candidate reasons, collaborates, and responds to feedback.

12.4%

GRADUATE UNEMPLOYMENT

33.6%

OVERALL UNEMPLOYMENT



South Africa, Q2 2026. This is context for the challenge, not proof of its cause.

Source: Statistics South Africa, QLFS Q2 2026.

WHO IT AFFECTS

A CYCLE WITH FEW CHANCES TO PROVE YOURSELF

No experience can mean fewer opportunities to gain experience.

Graduates need a first chance to build work history. Employers need credible signals before hiring. CVs and short interviews may not show how someone approaches a real task.



AFFECTED

Early-career graduates with limited formal experience.

DECISION-MAKERS

Employers and hiring managers.

Working model — needs validation: founder observations and project framing; no stakeholder interviews yet.

ROOT CAUSE

THE ROOT IS AN EVIDENCE GAP

Hiring teams need to make decisions with incomplete signals.

VISIBLE ON A CV



FORMAL JOB HISTORY

HARDER TO SEE

1 PRACTICAL REASONING

2 LEARNING

3 COLLABORATION

Working hypotheses — unvalidated: limited assessment time, reliance on familiar hiring signals, and uneven access to networks can reinforce the gap.

The project has not yet confirmed these causes through graduate or employer research.



THE SOLUTION

MAKE THE WORK VISIBLE

Show the process, not just the polished answer.

Think You Can Build gives employers a chance to observe graduates:

01 CLARIFY a problem

02 TEST an approach

03 EXPLAIN trade-offs

04 ADAPT to feedback

Design hypothesis — to test: a structured, role-relevant work sample can reveal useful evidence that a CV or short interview may miss.

HOW IT WORKS

ONE CHALLENGE. SEVERAL WAYS TO SHOW CAPABILITY.

Graduates solve the same case. Reviewers score the work.

3–5

GRADUATES

Make individual attempts in one facilitated call.

1

MOCK-COMPANY CASE

A facilitator introduces the business case and prompts participants to show their thinking.

2

REVIEWERS + RUBRIC

The facilitator and a second reviewer score with a shared rubric.

WATCH

VIEWERS ONLY

Viewers can watch; comments do not determine the winner.

PLANNED MVP WINNER BENEFITS

- Interview & presentation grooming
- CV review / building session

Delivery capacity still needs confirmation.

PROTOTYPE / PRODUCT DEMONSTRATION

THE PRODUCT IS AT CONCEPT STAGE

NOT BUILT YET

No working app, clickable prototype, or live challenge exists today.

PROPOSED DEMO FLOW



The first version is planned around existing call and streaming tools, with a lightweight website/dashboard.

TRACTION & VALIDATION

EVIDENCE SO FAR

The need has context. The concept still needs testing.

HAVE

OFFICIAL CONTEXT

Stats SA reported 12.4% graduate unemployment in Q2 2026.

ANECDOTAL

FOUNDER OBSERVATION

Peers from the founder's college cohorts have struggled to work in their field. This is anecdotal and not representative research.

MISSING

NO VALIDATION YET

No graduate survey, employer interviews, prototype test, pilot, or confirmed company partner.

NEXT EVIDENCE Survey graduates and interview employers before selecting the first field.

FEASIBILITY

START SMALL WITH EXISTING TOOLS

Test the format before building the full platform.

PROPOSED STACK · MERN

- React
- Node.js
- Express
- MongoDB

PROPOSED DELIVERY

CALLS

Teams or Meet

PRODUCTION

OBS or StreamYard

PUBLIC VIDEO

YouTube

MANUAL PILOT TEAM

1. Facilitator
2. Second reviewer
3. Moderator

Run one mock-case pilot manually. Build the full dashboard only after the workflow proves useful.

FEASIBILITY STATUS — UNTESTED

Solo founder today; no app, budget, team, or platform workflow confirmed.



EXPOSURE NEEDS SAFEGUARDS

Public visibility can create opportunity—and risk.

! Public streaming may exclude graduates who cannot or do not want to appear on camera.

! Consent does not erase the risks of a recording being copied or seen later.

! Live confidence, airtime, internet quality, and comments can distort perceptions.

! Real business cases can expose confidential information or raise ownership questions.

PROPOSED SAFEGUARDS

- Clear consent & reuse terms
- Mock cases first
- Moderated comments
- Equal prompts
- Individual evidence notes
- Independent scoring

A private or recorded participation option remains an open design decision.

SUCCESS METRICS

MEASURE EVIDENCE AND OPPORTUNITY

Success means employers learn something useful—and graduates get a fair chance to show it.

PILOT MEASURES

PARTICIPATION

Completion & withdrawal

FAIRNESS

Participant fairness feedback

RELIABILITY

Reviewer score agreement

VALUE

Employer usefulness

INTEREST

Follow-up requests

OPPORTUNITY

Confirmed interviews, shadowing, internships, or paid roles

VIEWS ≠ IMPACT

Views & likes = attention

Hiring outcomes = impact

Views and likes measure attention, not hiring impact.

NO IMPACT RESULTS EXIST YET

ROADMAP

PROVE THE FORMAT BEFORE SCALING

Next: research → prototype → dry run → pilot.

1

RESEARCH

Survey graduates and interview employers to select a computer-based field.

2

PROTOTYPE

Create one fictional business case, rubric, and facilitator guide.

3

DRY RUN

Test timing, access, and scoring with a dry run.

4

TERMS

Prepare consent, privacy, moderation, and solution-use terms.

5

PILOT

Run one small pilot and publish what the evidence shows.

Limits today: no product, research, pilot, employer partner, bounty, or placement outcome is confirmed. The format can add evidence; it cannot guarantee a job or solve unemployment on its own.

Stats SA QLFS Q2 2026: report · presentation